Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. My experience building NLP systems for document workflows, including deploying text classification models and monitoring their performance, aligns well with the team's work to route support requests and help merchants get answers quickly.

As an ML Engineer at Slavonica Document AI, I built a classifier for scanned incoming documents across 23 classes, achieving 94% accuracy and a macro F1 score of 0.91. I fine-tuned XLM-R base and deployed it as a FastAPI service in Docker on Azure App Service, where it processes approximately 15,000 documents per day. I have also built a Croatian named entity recognition model and created a 4,000-document annotated dataset, achieving an inter-annotator kappa of 0.87.

I bring experience with production monitoring as well as model development: a weekly drift report and alerting setup helped identify a silent OCR change that reduced accuracy by 9 points, and the issue was fixed within a week. I also have a personal weekend prototype for retrieval-augmented question answering over Croatian laws, using sentence embeddings and an open-weight LLM through an API. It was not used in production, but it gave me practical exposure to a RAG approach.

I am interested in applying my NLP and production ML experience to customer-support AI at Quillstone, where models and assistants are developed to answer merchant questions and support agents. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the team.

Sincerely,
Petra Zlatarić-Novosel